Khujand: New Base

Well, life was not going to remain the same for Babur. However, with a desire to make a comeback despite all adversaries, Babur had sent Qasim Beg Quchin to Tashkent seeking help from Sulṭān Mahmud Khān about a move on Andijān.

Qasim had been successful in persuading Khān and he arrived with the massive troop by the way of Ahangaran Dale reaching the foot of Kindirlik pass. Babur too reached there from Khujand and meet his maternal uncle Sulṭān Mahmud Khān. Together they crossed the pass and took a halt at the end of Akhsi.

The news of Babur coming with the support of his uncle Mahmud and troops had reached his enemies in Andijān. They too gathered and reached Akhsi.

And what happened next was beyond Babur's comprehension and expectations. He came to know that some misunderstandings and misleading were created among a pack of the army of Sulṭān Mahmud Khān, because of which the enemy stormed strong at it making it the weakest possible. According to Babur's writings, Sulṭān Mahmud Khān was a weak commander and meritless soldier.

Just when he could have saved Andijān by simply marching towards it (even without any fighting), he fell for the enemies' deceit. Auzun Hasan and Tambal promised heavy bribes and gifts to Khān and his intermediaries. Trapped in the web, Khān decided to retire, leaving Babur on his own.

Families and households of most of the Begs were in Andijān itself. Fearing the consequences, the forty scores of them decided not to march and cause any trouble. Instead, they decided to leave Babur in his condition. the begs who deserted included big names like Ali Darwesh, Ali Mazid Quchin, Muhammad Baqir, Shaikh Abdullah and the lord of the gate, Mirim Laghari.

But some choose to stay loyal to Babur in his time of imminent exile. The number of those loyalists won't be more than three hundred and it included Qasim Quchin Beg, Wais Laghari Beg, Ibrahim Saru, Minghlig Beg, Shirim Taghai, Sayyaidi Qara Beg. Few from Babur's household decided to stay back which included names like Mir Shah Quchin, the Lord of Gate Sayyid Qasim Jalair, Qasim Ajab, Muhamamd Dost, Muhammad